This is a soup that is easy to make in a hurry. All that's needed to bring out its fruity flavor is ample time to chill—and a perfectly ripe melon.

chilled melon and ginger soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 1 MONTH
AT THE END OF STEP 3

1 ripe Galia melon peeled and seeded
1in (2.5cm) piece fresh ginger
1 tsp fennel seeds
7oz (200g) white seedless grapes
juice and grated zest of 1 lime
1 tsp dried mint
4 tbsp Greek yogurt, beaten
salt and freshly ground black pepper

for the garnish
2 tbsp fresh mint leaves
pinch of sugar
1oz (25g) crystallized ginger, finely chopped

1 Coarsely chop three quarters of the melon flesh into bite-sized chunks. Finely chop the remainder and set aside. Coarsely grate the ginger and squeeze any juice over the melon chunks. Discard the leftover ginger.

2 Heat a sturdy frying pan over low heat and lightly toast the fennel seeds for about 30 seconds, until you smell an anise-like aroma. Grind the seeds to a coarse powder using a mortar and pestle.

3 Put the ground fennel seeds into a blender with the chopped melon and ginger juice. Add the grapes, lime juice and zest, and dried mint. Process until smooth and push through a sieve to remove the skins.

4 Stir in the yogurt, season, and chill thoroughly—it's best to half-freeze this soup, then quickly whisk it just before serving. Spoon into bowls, adding a small pile of the reserved melon to each one. Shred the fresh mint with the sugar, mix with the crystallized ginger and scatter over the soup, then serve immediately.